

TV SHOW

The Bad Batch

★★★★☆ | There is one approach to all the new Star Wars content dropping, which involves telling more parts of the story by setting it at a historic and important time. The Bad Batch is the continuation of the story of the Storm Troopers, showing what happens to the clones in the aftermath of the Clone Wars, when the remnants of the Republic pushed to the fringes. The Galactic Empire has taken hold, and like an efficient machine, it starts moving towards replacing the expensive clone troopers with cheaper recruits. The Bad Batch, or the Clone Force 99 a squad of “defective” clones have to find their way in the middle of this new galaxy, getting caught on the wrong side of their allegations,



they gravitate towards becoming mercenaries and looking out for themselves. The series picks up right where the final season of The Clone Wars left off, and shares a number

of interesting characters, including new favorites introduced in the final season, and the bounty hunters well known to long time fans of the series. Of course, for the latter the biggest draw to the series is the voice acting of Dee Bradley Baker, but these get full service because of the appearance of Rex himself. For those who liked the whole dynamic of the Mandalorian saving a kid from a bunch of competing factions and powerful actors, The Bad Batch offers something very similar. Instead of one, there are five soldiers who well, look pretty much like Mandalorians trying to save Omega, a kid who has genetic material that is apparently very important to the Kaminonian cloning industry. A bunch of grown men trying to do their best for a kid, while eking out a living on the fringes of the law is plenty of fodder for some good old fashioned action and adventure, which is what the series delivers.

ANIME

Rascal Does Not Dream of Bunny Girl Senpai

★★★★☆ | Misleading would be the right word for this title that is a lot more than meets the eye at first glance. While most “men of culture” are drawn towards the anime because of the same assumption, it turns out to be clickbait, but the kind you certainly won’t regret.

The main aspect of the story revolves around what is called “Puberty Syndrome”. The characters and their relationships are very lifelike, and the way they interact with each other is a delight to watch, especially Mai and Sakuta (the leading characters), who have such incredible chemistry and complement each other perfectly. Mai, the teenage actress (and our lil’ bunny



girl), especially, is a pivotal character for most of the show apart from the protagonist, and appears to have a more realistic touch to her personality. Sakuta is a rather cunning, interesting, and straightforward guy who presents his views in a monotonous way, giving him a uniquely funny aspect. Even the other characters and their concerns

are likewise carefully considered. Everything from the visuals and the acoustics give the viewer an immersive experience, making it easy for them to connect to the character(s). This includes the incredible voicework by the artists.

The only thing which ironically sets it a bit backwards is the story. Although the concepts and setting of the story appear exceptional, the seamless transition between each episode is somewhat missing. Almost every two episodes, in the 13 episodes long series, contribute to a standalone story, revolving particularly around some specific characters, their background and problems which result in alterations to the atmosphere, which ultimately is explained as a variety of the ‘Puberty Syndrome’. The script to the story includes everything from hints of mystery and romcom to heartbreaking moments.

Owing to its fame, we stumbled upon this beautiful piece and are more than willing to recommend it to anyone who’s into (or wishes to try out) slice of life, romcom, or mystery anime.